



**ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL**  
**General Certificate of Education Ordinary Level**

**ENGLISH FOR COMMUNICATION**

**4074/1**

PAPER 1

1 hour 30 minutes

**SPECIMEN PAPER**

Additional materials:  
Answer booklet

**INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES**

Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the spaces provided on the answer booklet.

Read the paper carefully before answering the questions.

Answer **two** questions.

Answer **one** question from **Section A** and **one** from **Section B**.

Write your answers on the separate answer booklet provided.

**INFORMATION FOR CANDIDATES**

The number of marks is given in brackets [ ] at the end of each question.

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**This specimen paper consists of 4 printed pages.**

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**SECTION A: GUIDED COMPOSITION (20 MARKS)**

Write a composition on **one** of the following guided compositions.

You are advised to **spend 40 minutes** on this section.

**Answer either 1(a) or (b)**

- 1 (a)** There has been an outbreak of bedbugs in your community. As a News Reporter for one of the local newspapers, you carried out an interview with the Councillor of the community to find out the extent of the problem.

Write an interview script between yourself and the Councillor.

Include the following points and any other relevant points of your own in your interview script.

- when the problem started.
- signs of infestation
- how the bugs spread
- area affected
- measures taken to curb the spread of bugs
- how to curb future outbreaks

[20]

- (b)** Imagine that you are the Head of Blue Mountain High School. You received the following letter from a concerned parent after you held a fund raising show at your school. Write a response, suggesting measures you will take to deal with the issues raised.

120 Magaba Drive  
Skyline Extension  
Gutu

20 May 2026

The Head  
Blue Mountain High School  
P O Box 31  
Gutu

Dear Sir

**Re: COMPLAINT ABOUT LEANERS' BEHAVIOUR AT THE RECENT  
FUND-RAISING SHOW.**

I write to register my complaint about the unbecoming behaviour by students at the recent fund-raising show held at your school.

I witnessed a group of girls who were skimpily dressed, loitering at the local shopping centre. The girls were wearing short skirts. I presumed that was meant to attract the attention of gold panners who were at the township.

On the other hand, boys from your school were visibly drunk and some hurled insults at the local vendors who tried to reprimand them. They had satchels which appeared to be loaded with alcoholic drinks and cigarettes. I wonder how they skipped school and managed to buy alcohol.

As a concerned parent, I am also worried about the number of fundraising activities being conducted at your school. Week after week, there is one fundraising activity after another. The school is milking us dry through these activities and, as parents, we feel the school is being inconsiderate.

We are struggling to raise funds for school fees. What is more disturbing is the fact that there is no development taking place at the school. How are these funds being used?

I would appreciate if you could highlight measures that will be taken to limit disruptions to learning as a result of countless fundraising activities. I am very much interested in knowing what actions you will take, as a school, to instil discipline during fund raising events at the school. I also feel that funds collected should be accounted for.

Concerned parent

Mrs Sipho Moyo.

[20]

**SECTION B: FREE COMPOSITION (20 MARKS)**

Write a composition on one of the following topics. Your answer should be between **320** and **400** words in length. You are advised to **spend 50 minutes** on this section.

- |          |                                                                                                                                 |      |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>2</b> | Describe the scene at an important cultural celebration.                                                                        | [20] |
| <b>3</b> | Write a story based on the following:<br>'His stay at the rehabilitation centre helped him to overcome addiction.'              | [20] |
| <b>4</b> | Write a dialogue between a parent and a child. The parent wishes the child to study Sciences yet the child wants to study Arts. | [20] |
| <b>5</b> | Suggest ways of promoting children's rights in your community.                                                                  | [20] |
| <b>6</b> | 'Corporal punishment is a dehumanising way of instilling discipline and should not have a place in our schools.' Do you agree?  | [20] |